

The Natural Environment	
Environments	
	Essential content
Apply	- The hydrological cycle: characteristics - Features of a drainage basin, its network. - The hydrograph and river regime (precipitation, temperature, land use, dams).
Understand	- Processes: weathering and mass movement. Factors affecting the rate of erosion (velocity, slope, geology). - River channel changes downstream: meanders, oxbow lakes, floodplains, interlocking spurs, waterfalls, flood plains and levees.
Explain	- The uses of water: agriculture, industry, domestic. The demand for and supply of water. Shortage and water surplus. - Reasons for variations in water resources (climate, topography, land use, population, industrial waste, agricultural practices, water conservation works). - Flooding: causes (intensity of rainfall, land use, impermeable surfaces, human activities).

Natural Environment Physical environments					
	Essential content	Scale	Required case studies	Recommended fieldwork opportunities (F) and practical skills (P)	
Give a description of the coastal environment.	- The coast as a natural system and its processes: marine (wave action, erosion, deposition, longshore drift); sub-aerial (weathering, mass movement). - Landforms: erosional (headlands and bays; cliffs; wave-cut platforms; caves; arches, stacks and stumps); depositional (beaches, spits, bars). - The impact of geology, vegetation, people and sea-level changes on coasts.	Regional and small (local)	1 Case study of two geologically contrasting coastlines.	Annotated sketches based on photographs (F/P). Investigating beach profiles and sediment characteristics (F).	
Describe the coastal environment.	- Coastal ecosystems (coral reefs, mangroves, sand dunes, salt marshes) and their biodiversity. - Physical factors affecting the distributions of coastal ecosystems. - Coastal ecosystems are of value to people, but are threatened by tourism and other developments (industrialisation, agricultural practices, deforestation).	Global and small (local)	2 Case study of one coastal ecosystem.	Investigation of coastal ecosystems based on maps, photographs and other sources of information (P).	
Describe the coastal environment.	- Conflicts between different users of the coast and between development and conservation. - Coastal retreat and its management. Coastal protection: soft and hard engineering; conflicting views.	National, regional and small (local)	3 Case study of a retreating coastline – causes, impacts and management.	Investigating the conflicts between development and conservation on a stretch of coastline (F).	

Natural Environment				
Geographical context of natural environments				
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Core content	• Different types of hazard (climatic, tectonic). • The global distributions, causes and characteristics of: tropical storms, volcanoes and earthquakes. • Methods of monitoring weather conditions.	Global and regional		Mapping the global distribution of recent hazards (P). Investigating weather conditions (F).
Impact	• Identifying the scale of natural disasters and their short-term and long-term impact in countries at different levels of development. • Reasons why people continue to live in areas at risk from hazard events.	Regional and small (local)	1 A case study of the comparative impacts of a tropical storm in an LIC and an HIC.	Research into a recent hazard event (P).
Hazards on the ground before and after	• Predicting and preparing for hazards (education, early warning systems, shelters, defences). • Coping during hazards (evacuation, mitigation). • Consequences of hazards: short-term (emergency aid and disaster relief); long-term (risk assessment, rebuilding, review and adjustment, improving prediction and preparation).	National	2 Case study of the management of a tectonic event. 3 Case study of the management of either river flooding or coastal flooding.	Investigating people's views on the management of a hazard event (F).

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tor: primary, nic sectors changes with d within countries. acteristics. and growth of tertiary aw technology, icy). of manufacturing (TNCs, government policy).	Global, national and regional Regional Global	1 A comparative study of sectoral shifts in one HIC and one LIC. 2 Case study of the factors affecting the development and location of one high-tech industry. 3 Case study of a de-industrialised area – causes, consequences and subsequent ‘development’.	Graphical representation of employment sector data (P). Investigating the location factors of factories or services (F).
nergy gap. and the need for energy eg wind, tidal and energy (eg fossil fuels	Global, national and small (local)		Research into energy sources of home country (P). Investigating people’s conflicting views on the use and impacts of renewable and non-renewable energy (F).